

Human Resources

Question Booklet

Past HSC and trial questions from your Drive, screenshotted exactly as they appeared in the original papers.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Section A — Multiple choice	Q1–18	18 questions	18 marks	p. 2
Section B — Short answer	Q19–44	26 questions	88 marks	p. 7
Section C — 20-mark questions	Q45–46	2 questions	40 marks	p. 23

How to use this booklet

1. **Section A** – multiple choice: circle one answer (about 1.5 min each).
2. **Section B** – short answers. Each question shows the paper it came from and its marks, and has the same number of writing lines as the original paper (about 1.8 min per mark).
3. **Section C** – the 20-mark questions are on the last pages: plan in the box, then write in full on separate paper.
4. Check your answers in the matching **Answer Booklet** – question numbers are identical.

Section A — Multiple choice

Circle the best answer. About 1.5 minutes each.

Q1 Newington Trial 2023 · Q3

3. Which of the following are BOTH key functions of human resource management?

A.	Maximising product output	Minimising product defects
B.	Maximising shareholder value	Minimising tax liabilities
C.	Maximising market share	Minimising customer complaints
D.	Maximising employee productivity	Minimising workplace disputes

Q2 SIC Trial 2024 · Q1

1 Budgeting for the acquisition of staff needs is an example of interdependence between which of the following business functions?

- A. Finance and marketing
- B. Marketing and operations
- C. Finance and human resources
- D. Operations and human resources

Q3 Roseville Trial 2023 · Q4

4 An Australian software company pays a software developer to complete programing work for a new computer game they are making. The software developer completes the work from their home in Lebanon and is then paid a fee in exchange for this work. The developer then moves onto another project for a different company.

In this scenario, the worker in Lebanon is

- (A) a global contractor.
- (B) a domestic contractor.
- (C) a full-time permanent employee of the Australian company.
- (D) a part-time permanent employee of the Australian company.

Q4 Newington Trial 2023 · Q12

12. The Teacher's Federation of NSW is an organisation which seeks to improve the conditions of employment for its members. Which of the following workplace stakeholders is it?
- A. Employer
 - B. Employee
 - C. Employer association
 - D. Trade Union
-

Q5 2020 HSC · Q12

- 12 A NSW employer develops a return to work plan in consultation with an insurer and an injured employee.

Which legislation requires the employer to undertake this action?

- A. *Fair Work Act 2009* (Cth)
 - B. *Workers Compensation Act 1987* (NSW)
 - C. *Work Health and Safety Act 2011* (NSW)
 - D. *Australian Human Rights Commission Act 1986* (Cth)
-

Q6 Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q2

2. Which of the following organisations is responsible for applying the Better Off Overall (BOOT) test to enterprise agreements?

- a) Fair Work Act 2009
 - b) Fair Work Commission
 - c) Australian Securities and Investment Commission
 - d) Australian Council of Trade Unions
-

Q7 Independent Trial 2024 · Q17

- 17 An economy is experiencing a period of high economic growth during an expansion phase in the business cycle.

Which of the following changes in human resource management strategies is most likely to occur?

- A. A decrease in non-financial rewards
 - B. A decrease in the availability of suitably skilled employees
 - C. A decrease in the number of employees recruited and retained
 - D. An increase in the number of redundancy packages offered to employees
-

Q8 SIC Trial 2024 · Q7

7 A business currently allows employees to work from home two days a week out of five.

Which influence is impacting the HR decision of this business?

- A. Social
 - B. Legal
 - C. Parental
 - D. Economic
-

Q9 Newington Trial 2023 · Q16

16. Which of the following best describes the process of induction?

- A. Hiring a new employee
 - B. Introducing a new employee to the business culture
 - C. Providing reward to high performing employees
 - D. An employee signing an employment contract
-

Q10 Roseville Trial 2024 · Q10

10 A software development company has recently implemented several initiatives to improve employee satisfaction and retention. These initiatives include regular performance reviews, ongoing training programs, comprehensive health, and wellness benefits, and creating a positive work environment.

Which of the human resources processes is demonstrated by the company's initiatives?

- (A) Acquisition
 - (B) Training and Development
 - (C) Maintenance
 - (D) Separation
-

Q11 2022 HSC · Q2

2 Which of the following is a type of voluntary separation in the workplace?

- A. Dismissal
 - B. Layoff
 - C. Resignation
 - D. Retrenchment
-

Q12 2019 HSC · Q3

- 3 A business in crisis needs to make immediate and timely decisions in order to survive.

Which leadership style does a manager of this business need to adopt?

- A. Autocratic
- B. Bureaucratic
- C. Democratic
- D. Laissez-faire

Q13 2012 Trial (from your MC bank) · Q4

- 4 The human resources department has been given the task of developing and specifying the activities of new employees.

Which of the following best describes this function?

- (A) Job rotation
- (B) Job design
- (C) Recruitment
- (D) Induction

Q14 2020 HSC · Q1

- 1 Which row of the table shows benefits of both staff training and staff development?

	<i>Staff training</i>	<i>Staff development</i>
A.	Increase staff skills	Increased staff turnover
B.	Increase staff skills	Retain experienced staff
C.	Decrease in workplace accidents	Increased staff turnover
D.	Decrease in workplace redundancies	Retain experienced staff

Q15 Knox Trial 2023 · Q16

- 16 Weiling Supermarkets conducts annual appraisals of staff. The purpose of this is to plan for collective staff training needs in the future.

Which of the following best describes the type of performance management strategy being used?

- A. Developmental
- B. Individual
- C. Administrative
- D. Group

Q16 2022 HSC · Q6

- 6 All staff in a business participate equally in a profit-sharing scheme.

Which row of the table correctly identifies this reward strategy?

	<i>Reward</i>	<i>Staff</i>
A.	Monetary	Group
B.	Monetary	Individual
C.	Non-monetary	Group
D.	Non-monetary	Individual

Q17 2019 HSC · Q10

- 10 What is the common sequence for resolving workplace disputes?

- A. Mediation, negotiation, involvement of courts and tribunals
- B. Negotiation, mediation, involvement of courts and tribunals
- C. Involvement of courts and tribunals, negotiation, mediation
- D. Negotiation, involvement of courts and tribunals, mediation

Q18 2019 HSC · Q18

Use the following information to answer Questions 17 and 18.

The table compares four businesses on an annual basis.

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
Absenteeism (average per employee)	8	5	8	5
Accidents per 500 employees	4	2	2	4
% of staff turnover	11	9	9	11
Average output per employee	10	14	10	14

- 18 Which business is likely to be managing its human resources most effectively?

- A. *A*
- B. *B*
- C. *C*
- D. *D*

Section B — Short answer

Write your answer on the lines. Aim for about 1.8 minutes per mark.

Q19

Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (a)

2 marks

a) Outline the strategic role of the human resource function. (2 marks)

Q20

Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (c)

4 marks

The table below contains data concerning a business in 2021 and 2022.

	2021	2022
Human Resources costs	\$2 600 000	\$2 000 000
Training expenditure per employee	\$1900	\$1500
Absenteeism per employee	10 days	14 days
Accidents per 1000 employees	50	30
Number of strike days	2	10
Staff turnover	15%	10%

c) Using the data, analyse the interdependence between human resources management and financial management in this business. (4 marks)

Q21 2021 HSC · Question 23 (b)

2 marks

(b) Why might a business use a contractor to recruit staff?

2

Q22 Barker Trial 2024 · Question 24 (a)

2 marks

(a) Outline ONE disadvantage of outsourcing human resources functions.

2

Q23 2020 HSC · Question 21 (a)

2 marks

(a) Outline the role of ONE external stakeholder who represents the interests of employees in workplace disputes.

2

Q24 2019 HSC · Question 23 (b)

4 marks

- (b) Distinguish between awards and enterprise agreements.

4

Q25 2022 HSC · Question 22 (b)

3 marks

- (b) Outline how the minimum employment standards protect employees in Australia. Use examples in your answer.

3

Q26 2023 HSC · Question 22 (a)

2 marks

- (a) What is the purpose of Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) legislation?

2

- (b) The advertisement for a store manager is shown.



Teddy Bear Store

Est. 1990

Teddy Bear Store aims to bring joy to children.

We are looking for a Store Manager. If you are interested, please contact us.

<u>Role:</u>	<u>Responsibilities:</u>	<u>General information:</u>
– Manage a team of 8 staff members	– Organise inventory	– \$65 000 salary
– Manage day-to-day operations	– Train staff	– Union membership not permitted
	– Assist customers	– No superannuation included

Outline TWO human resource issues found in this advertisement.

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

(d) Explain the impact of a recession on Mango Airlines human resource management. 4

- 4

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5

<i>Year</i>	<i>Males</i>	<i>Females</i>
1981	78%	44%
2001	73%	55%
2021	71%	62%

Explain the social influences that have contributed to the changing labour force participation rates in the period 1981–2021.

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6

- (c) In recent times governments have imposed restrictions on businesses such as lockdowns, social distancing and the movement of people. As a result, businesses have changed the way their employees work and communicate with each other.

Discuss the possible implications of these influences on human resource management.

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- (b) Discuss TWO benefits for business of embracing corporate social responsibilities and ethical practices. **4**

- (d) Explain the importance of carrying out an induction program for new employees. **3**

(c) Explain how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.

4

[illegible]

(b) Distinguish between voluntary and involuntary separation.

4

(a) Identify TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business. 2

Use the following information to answer the question below

5

Raj owns a business that designs security software. His business is rapidly expanding due to the increase in companies allowing their employees to work from home. Raj needs to increase his workforce to keep up with his demand. The work is complicated and requires excellent knowledge of coding and software design.

Due to the expansion, Raj requires more employees in management roles.

(c) Discuss the strategy of internal recruitment for Raj.

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Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

- (c) Discuss ONE training and development strategy Mango airlines could use to train and develop its staff. 3

- (c) How are performance appraisals of employees beneficial to employers? 3

- (b) Explain ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management.

3

- (b) Describe the role of grievance procedures in human resource management.

3

HiFashion is a fast fashion retail store with 40 stores located around Australia and employ 200 staff. Management is concerned with the reduction in productivity and staff feedback it has received. Staff cited rewards, leadership style and dispute resolution methods as key to their dissatisfaction.

Extract of data:

Indicator	2021	2022
Staff turnover	10%	20%
Employee satisfaction	80%	65%
Number of disputes	10 per year	25 per year

- (a) Explain how HiFashion could implement TWO appropriate dispute resolution methods that would reduce the current number of disputes.

4

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

- (a) Outline how corporate culture can affect staff turnover.

2

Section C — 20-mark questions

A business report and an essay. Plan in the box, then write on separate paper (about 35 minutes each).

Q45 2019 HSC · Question 25

20 marks

A business, Roo's Outback Eatery Pty Ltd, is opening an additional restaurant in NSW. They plan to position the restaurant as an exclusive restaurant specialising in modern Australian food with quality customer service. The owners require assistance with the following:

- the acquisition and development of suitable staff
- additional funds for the day-to-day running of the business
- the close monitoring of working capital.

You have been hired as a consultant to write a report for the owners. In your report:

- discuss methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff
- recommend TWO appropriate working capital management strategies for this business.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Evaluate human resource strategies used to achieve THREE indicators of effective human resource management.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.